

MINUTES

A **Committee of the Whole Meeting** is convened on **April 10, 2023** and scheduled from 4:30 - 6pm. The meeting is held in the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall as well as via remote participation on Zoom and viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 15 and Verizon Channel 45.

The purpose of the meeting is for Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent to make a 3rd budget presentation of the Fiscal Year 2024 Medford Public Schools Operating Budget to the Medford School Committee for FY24 funding requests, focusing on Strategic Priorities concerning equitable supports for our most vulnerable students. present updates to the Budget presentation for the Fiscal Year 2024.

The Agenda is as Follows:

A presentation regarding the Fiscal Year 2024 Medford Public Schools Operating Budget to the Medford School Committee for FY24 funding requests, reviewing the past expenditures and remaining FY24 ESSER Funds, and analyzing the districts Strategic Priorities concerning equitable supports by Superintendent of Schools, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent

Member Ruseau takes Roll Call: 7/0

Member Mustone participated via Zoom

Mayor Lungo-Koehn turns the meeting over to Superintendent Edouard-Vincent.

Dr. Cushing manages the presentation: FY24 Budget Update Meeting #3

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent presents the budget update before the committee and based on questions that came in from the members and were asked last week, she is attempting to respond to providing answers for the majority of the questions. She asks Dr. Cushing to start the presentation and proceeds to explain for members of the community who are joining for the first time, and are not certain how school budgets function, the different funding streams that are available to school districts.

Slide 2: Lanes Toward Budget Adoption

- **Commonwealth**
 - Governor's Budget (Cherry Sheet)
 - House Ways & Means
 - Senate Ways & Means
 - Conference Committee
 - Budget Adoption
- **City**
 - Chapter 70 Allocation
 - Local Aide (UGGA)
 - Local Contribution
 - NSS/Foundation Budget
- **MPS**
 - District Priorities/Goals
 - Departmental Priorities/Goals
 - Superintendent's Recommends
 - Budget Meeting Process
 - School Committee Request
 - Municipal Appropriations School Committee Adoption

- **Federal Government**

- Examples of External Funds (Intended to Supplement not Supplant): Federal and state grants, i.e.: Title I, Title IV, Perkins Grant, IDEA COVID-19 Virus Relief Fund (DESE)
These allocations fluctuate yearly
- *Federal relief*
- Misc. Additional Funding
- Sources for Specific Purposes: Capital Improvements; Circuit Breaker; USDA Reimbursements

Slide 3: MPS Funding Sources

- General Fund Allocation
- Grants (IDEA, Title Grants)
- ESSER (One-Time Funding Source)
- Revolving Accounts

Slide 4: FY24 Budget Process and Tentative Timeline

Reviewing and Approving the district's operating budget is an important annual function, but one that is dependent upon several other components of government, i.e. state government (ch.70, etc.) school administration, mayor and city council.

- Strategic Plan/Goals < approved in June ✓
- Budget Surveys < March 7- March 17 ✓
- Budget Meetings < April 3 ✓ April 10 ✓ May 1
- Superintendent's Recommendation < TBD
- School Committee Request < May 15 or June 5
- Municipal Appropriation < June TBD
- School Committee Adoption < June 12
- Implementation July 1

Slide 5: Budget Objectives

Date and Topic:

April 3: Introduction to the Budget Process - Review FY23 allocation

April 10: FY24 funding requests, reviewing the available FY24 ESSER funds, and highlighting priorities

May 1: Superintendent Recommendations on the Strategic Priorities for MPS

Slide 6: FY23 Budget Numbers:

MPS FY23 Adopted Operating Budget Approved in June, 2022 | \$68,994,776

Slide 7: FY24 Budget Numbers:

MPS FY24 Anticipated Operating Budget to be Approved in June, 2023 | \$71,000,000

Slide 8: MPS FY24 Anticipated Operating Budget

MPS FY24 Anticipated Operating Budget to be Approved in June, 2023 | \$1.7 M increase (2.5%)

Slide 9: Employment Agreements / MPS Budget

Fiscal Year, Contractual Increase, Budgetary Impact:

FY22: 2.5% - \$960k (was paid retroactively from FY22)

FY23: 2.5% - \$1m (paid from additional funding that was incorporated into the FY 23 budget, represented by the anticipated 2% increase and other nominal savings)

FY24: 2.5% + 1% (100th day) - \$1.1m fixed cost increase based on FY 23 increase (teachers only)

What does this mean: The reason that base salary increases were such a frequent topic of discussion through FY 22 and FY23 budget cycles is that each of these increases are incorporated into the base, meaning they necessitate essentially a \$3m increase in the base operating budget.

Slide 10: Fixed Cost Increases

In each budget process, we look to ascertain fixed cost increases to determine what the evolution of the operating budget will be from one fiscal year to the next. The two primary drivers of fixed cost increases are typically contractual increases (as noted in the previous slide and below) and Special Education costs (increases in out-of-district tuitions and transportations costs):

- FY 24 Special Education increases are projected to amount to \$1m (\$500k in transportation, \$500k in tuitions).
- FY 24 contractual increases amount to \$3.3m in increases to personnel expenses
 - A significant portion (2% in FY 22 and 2% in FY 23) of these increases were incorporated into the last two budgets in anticipation of negotiated increases. Still with the FY 23 and 24 increases exceeding the budgeted amounts, a sizable portion of the flexibility previously represented in the budgets is now eliminated.
- FY 24 vendor increases, i.e. transportation and maintenance increases are estimated at this time to be in the vicinity of 100k.
- MPS still has outstanding expired collective bargaining agreements with the Teamsters and SEIU, representing administrators, custodians, security monitors and food service workers.

Slide 11: FY24 Anticipated Increases

- Out-of-District Tuition (14% increase) | \$3.7M FY23 \$4.2M FY24 (Approx)
- Transportation/Van (10% increase) | \$1.5M FY23 \$2.2M FY 24 (Approx)
- Transportation/School Bus | \$1.2M FY23 (Approx) \$1.25M FY24 (Approx)

Slide 12: FY24 Anticipated Increases

- Utilities (Gas & Electric) | \$1.85M FY23 \$2M FY24 (Approx)
- Cleaning Contract | \$400K FY22 \$445K FY23 \$TBD FY24

Slide 13: Fixed Cost Increases Approximate Total

Approximately \$1.4 M Increase in ordinary expenses (non-salary) + \$ 3.3 M in personnel expenses (settled CBAs) = \$4.7 M increase (6.8%) ~\$74 M request

Slide 14: FY23 and FY 24 ESSER Estimated Budget

Miscellaneous (FY23) | FY24 (exp)

- SEL/Counseling Programs: \$80K | \$80K
- Supervision & Evaluation Professional Development: \$30K | \$26K
- Talking Points & Other Subscriptions: \$50K | TBD

Technology (FY23) | FY24 (exp)

- Emergency Connectivity Fund (ECF): \$90K | TBD

Transportation (FY23) | FY24 (exp)

- MBTA Bus Pass Program: \$150K | \$202K

Summer Programming (FY23) | FY24 (exp)

- Camp Mustang (Funds Dependent): TBD | TBD

Slide 15: FY23 and FY 24 ESSER Estimated Budget

Personnel Expenditures (FY23) | FY24 (exp)

- 5.0 Engagement Specialists: \$220K | \$150K
- 101 School Nurses: \$60K | TBD
- 3.0 Behavioral Specialists: \$125K | \$130K
- 1.0 Reading Specialist: \$100K | \$200K

- 1.0 ELL Newcomer: \$0K6 | TBD
- Contractual Stipends: \$1.6M | \$750K

Professional Learning (FY23) | FY24 (exp)

- Hill for Literacy: \$90K | ~\$90K
- Responsive Classroom / Restorative Justice: \$65K | ~\$100K

Note: ESSER funding (COVID-related funding from the federal government specifically earmarked for use by school districts like MPS, will expire in the first quarter of FY 25, meaning the FY 24 (July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2024) is essentially the final year that MPS will have access to ESSER funding. ESSER I and ESSER II are essentially expired, and ESSER III is the basis for most of these anticipated expenses. MPS will need to make determination throughout FY 24 what expenses will need to be retired and/or what will need to be incorporated into the operating budget when ESSER funds are no longer at the district's disposal.

Slide 16: FY24 Proposed Final ESSER Budget

Est. MPS FY24 Projected ESSER Expenditures | \$3.2 Million

Proposed Items for Allocation | Estimated Cost

- Curriculum - New Elementary Literacy Program | ~\$600,000 (including an additional 200K from DESE grant)
- Restorative Justice & Bystander Intervention (Secondary) | ~\$100,000
- HILL for Literacy (Elementary) | ~\$90,000

Slide 17: Total ESSER Funding for MPS

ESSER Funding | Total Allotted | Balance Remaining (EOY FY 23)

ESSER I	\$668,052	\$0
ESSER II	\$2,372,520	\$0
ESSER III	\$5,309,620	~\$3,200,000
Total:	 \$8,350,192	 ~\$3,200,000

**ESSER 3 funding must be spent by September 30, 2024. That is the Federal fiscal year end.*

Slide 17: FY24 Budgetary Priorities

Category: Strategic staffing investments focused on our most vulnerable learners

Needs*

- Literacy interventionists
- Social workers/adjustment counselors
- Expanded school day staff
- Theatre Teacher, CTE expansion
- **OT & SLP 2.0 FTE**

Category: Professional development & training

Needs*

- Building-based professional development
- District-wide professional development
 - Restorative Practices/Responsive Classroom
 - Curriculum training (elementary math and literacy)

Category: Summer programming (Grant Dependent)

Needs*

- Literacy, Math, Fine Arts, SEL programs to add to traditional array of summer programming options

Category: Misc. departmental supplements

Needs*

- High School Scheduling consultants
- Elementary scheduling/staffing (**Specialists 4.0 FTE**)

**Reflects preliminary information and is subject to change as a result of budget surveys.*

Slide 18: Ongoing Reconciliation Process

Reconciliation Process:

- Identification of existing budgetary capacity (savings on instructional materials, grade level strand collapsing)
- Identification of external funding sources as appropriate
- Identification of revolving funds funding sources as appropriate
- Potential Reduction in Positions
- Identification of capital expenditures appropriate for one-time funding sources
- Deferral of some strategic priorities

Slide 20: FY 24 Budget Drivers

- Growing Student Needs
 - SEL
 - Intervention
- Rising Costs & Expenses (New CBAs)\
 - Teachers
 - Nurses
 - Paras
 - Secretarial
 - Carpenters
 - TBD**
 - Admin
 - Custodians
 - Monitors
 - Cafeteria
- Using Special Revenue Funds
 - ESSER (One-time)
 - Grants
 - Revolving

Slide 21: MPS will continue to

- Keep students at the center of the decision-making
- Providing data to support student-centered learning
- Educators will still be provided professional development
- The partnership with our community will support students
- The families/ caregivers will continue to partner with Medford Public Schools
- MPS will still prepare students for college and career readiness

- MPS will still continue to thrive in supporting a sense of belonging:

Multi-Tiered System of Support (MTSS) Diagram shows:

Credit: S. Schulman - March 2023

Progress Monitoring of:

Tier 3: (High-Risk Students) - Individual Interventions (3-5% of all students)

Tier 2: (At-Risk Students) (sufficient for approx. 7-10%)- Intensified classroom and small group Interventions)

Referrals and Student Support Teams (SST)

Tier 1: (All Students) - Classroom strategies with accommodation planning (sufficient for approx. 85-90% of students.

Slide 22: FY24 Strategic Priorities to Support Medford Students

PRIORITY #1: Implement Curricula, Assessment & Instructional Strategies to Support All Students

PRIORITY #2: Building Culture Through Community Engagement

PRIORITY #3 Equitably Support the Academic, SEL, & Physical Needs of Students

PRIORITY #4 School Infrastructure Supports Student Learning

Slide 23: Thank You and Q&A

Questions from the Committee:

Member Ruseau appreciates the presentation and is much more aware of our situation from the last meeting. He notes the budgetary priorities do not have a dollar figure listed and they're not included in any totals anywhere.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent confirms that is so and they're not mapped out for viewing yet..

Member Ruseau continues; he wants to translate savings on instructional materials to mean PTO's go back to buying paper; sometimes things sound very different than they do in real life. He references slide 19 (*when asked*) and he has a list of things, (not a comprehensive list) however, many (committee members) expected to happen in the next year;
Director of Communications: he presumes that is gone.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds - answer is no; that and the Finance positions are still open.

Member Ruseau continues to add that those will need to be added somewhere as additional costs here.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent comments that the position for the Director of Communications is not perceived as a new position; there is a retirement coming and the salary (for the replacement) would not be dramatically higher.

Member Ruseau mentions the health curriculum and asks if we should just give up on that for next year.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that the plans for HECAT are moving forward.

Member Ruseau mentions he is on the HECAT Committee and speaks of any curriculum we purchase -

or questions if there are free ones even, that are not bad, they do nothing on their own and are going to require a vast amount of money to train staff. Hundreds of thousands is a minimum is his guess. We don't know as we haven't gotten that far in the process. But there's no getting us to the point where we stopped teaching harmful health curriculum, which is what we have right now in Medford. One of the professionals in our committee said if we teach nothing, it would be an improvement over what we have as a curriculum. He continues that it's probably that staff isn't following the curriculum and is doing better, but the approved curriculum right now is harmful. He doesn't care what the new health curriculum costs, when the professionals in health education tell us it would be better if children are allowed to watch YouTube, or play a video game in the classroom instead of learning what they should be taught.

Member Ruseau queries theater and the teacher who presented in the previous School Committee meeting; is this not going to make the list?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that theater is still something being considered to be offered to students in the district and they are in the process of looking at other ways to creatively provide this to students. With reconciliation, it is also being considered at potentially, creatively looking at some of the existing staff.... It might be a 1.0 but it is something they still want to be able to offer to students. She states we're committed to provide the greatest amount of opportunities for the students.

Member Ruseau asks: How many people are currently employed that are on expiring funds. When he looks at other districts, they are trying to do 2 and 3 year budgets. He recognizes that part of that process is theoretical because the money doesn't come yet but we are one year away from having everybody that we pay out of ESSER being on the street. While he cares very much about them, he cares, to a greater extent, for the services that they're providing to students that will cease and stop completely because they will not be employed here. Are we talking 5 or 50 people? He recognizes the number may not be available but requests it for the next meeting or receive it in a report. He does not have a good sense of who we're paying for and would like to know how many people (that work for us) are being paid out of ESSER funds - what their positions are and what they do. This is the next budget step we're going to face but it's very relevant now. When we're making decisions about what to cut now, it matters and how to afford to keep critical people.

Member Hays speaks: she is wondering about the new Literacy Curriculum and has the same question as Member Ruseau with regard to the health curriculum. We (the school district) are going to need literacy coaches or some other kind of professional development to go with the new curriculum. We are going to be spending a lot of money on a curriculum that is not going to get fully implemented if teachers don't have the support they need. She questions if this (item) is built into this budget or is that another thing we're going to be trying to figure out how to make happen?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that Hill (for Literacy) does provide some coaching and counseling. She asks Ms. Galusi to share what Hill has provided. She notes that there isn't a total number of coaches as yet and does not have a hard number to provide and queries if it is something where we would need to add 2.0 literacy coaches for a new program and provide professional development and training for teachers.

Suzanne Galusi takes the podium and speaks and confirms as mentioned previously, the membership for Hill for Literacy has been able to provide a level of coaching for this year, K-3 staff, but predominantly the focus has been K-2, which will continue for next year. In terms of what you (Member Hays) is specifically speaking about, she doesn't think that's reflected right now in additional coaching positions for the district. She continues that we (the district) can look creatively and it's a need down the road, but right now we have the Hill for Literacy piece.

Member Hays asks if they provide coaching specifically around the new curriculum or are they still providing coaching around equity? She has been looking at these curriculums - they are massive, as they all are. There are so many components and so many places where teachers are going to need some support and understanding. What do I implement? What do I need to ignore? She is concerned that a lot of money will be spent on a very necessary curriculum that's not going to be implemented correctly.

Suzanne Galusi acknowledges that concern and will share that feedback. She shares that the part of the high quality materials grant that was just received from the Department of Education (\$200K), which is the highest threshold that is given out to municipalities, also includes coaching - it comes along with the purchase of the program. Hill for Literacy is an approved vendor through the Department of Education and they will be assisting us in implementing the new programs.

Member Hays asks if the kind of coaching they provide - is it somebody that's actually housed in the building? When you (one) thinks of a coach that we (the district) would hire as a school system, they would be hopefully, in theory, one in each building across the grade levels - that their home would be the building.

Suzanne Galusi acknowledges that would be the hope and the dream but hasn't gotten to that level yet, as they're still selecting the program. She would guess they are not going to be a dedicated person every single day. Right now, the way the coaching model works with Hill for Literacy, they (coaches) are there, at each building twice a month.

Member Hays comments that that's not going to do it for a brand new Literacy curriculum. She acknowledges that Ms. Galusi is working hard and her comments are not directed at Ms. Galusi, but she is saying to the powers that be, that's not going to cut it for our brand new Literacy Curriculum especially when the science of reading is being implemented. She knows that teachers are already learning that through equity but it's a whole new massive material - a whole new style of teaching or pedagogical shift. Twice a month - that would be for each school?

Suzanne Galusi reiterates that we are not there yet because right now the programs are still being reviewed. That will be the next level of work, after we have selected the appropriate program.

Member Graham speaks and refers to a Point of Information on Slide 16 - which covers some of the way the ESSER funds are planned to be spent next year and questions if these amounts include professional development. It appears that it does include the curriculum and Hill for Literacy and she is looking for clarification whether the professional development associated with the new curriculum is on this page as an ESSER expenditure or not.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that for restorative justice and RJ Bystander, the approximate \$100K does include professional development and invites Dr Cushing to speak to the Bystander intervention if, in fact

Member Graham interjects and states she was referring to the Hill for Literacy numbers on that slide.

Suzanne Galusi states it will and Hill for Literacy will be in addition to whatever program we're going with. The professional development that's associated with or comes with the 6 year package/cost, the Hill for Literacy is in addition to the professional development that the program will provide.

Member Graham asks if the \$800K on the first line includes professional development.

Suzanne Galusi confirms - yes, that is recommended by the current vendor.

Member Graham comments that if she is reading the slide correctly, the plan is to pay for the curriculum and the recommended associated professional development for the literacy curriculum through after next year - is that true?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that's what they're look at, where the ESSER money technically ends on September 30, 2023, that if the \$600K and potential say we're going pay \$200K on ESSER and defer \$200K to FY25 - because the money has to be spent by September and you cannot pre-encumber a person's salary. If we were to set aside a little bit of money, it would need to be on a program ... she is not aware if the HECAT team would have a recommendation potentially coming up for something ... so it would make sense that, for example, on July 15 a \$200K payment could be made and

be in compliance with the ESSER rules, making that final payment before September 30. She did not do it as a separate slide, but the 3.2M, which is the current balance ... maybe \$750K could be set aside to pay for a little bit of programming. Because we had the \$250K for the math that was on the operating budget. The Literacy - we were trying to put it on the ESSER because it qualifies. It is up to the committee to decide.

Member Hays wants to clarify that there's the professional development that you're (we're) asking about the funding for that. What she is specifically asking about is coaching, which is different from professional development - the ongoing coaching that teachers need to have somebody in the building when they need to troubleshoot. It's really not just a frivolous extra expenditure - it's really needed when you're implementing a brand new program like this. She points out that they haven't implemented stuff like this in 10 plus years.

Chair Mayor Lungo-Koehn asks a question (of Member Hays), if she were to be implementing this (curriculum), how long would teachers need coaching? Are we talking about a full year? Are we talking about multiple years?

Member Hays confirms at least a couple of years. It's a big program; it's not just a continuation of what has been done before. When you get into that K-2 piece, that's the science of reading and even beyond that, it really ... continues that piece of morphology ... maybe they're doing that already but she thinks it is much more comprehensive than what has been had and one cannot undervalue that having coaches there to really make sure they continue to implement it, because if the teachers don't have the support, that's when things start to fall apart.

Member Hays continues with a question associated with Slide 19; she inquires into the potential for reduction in positions - which is a really huge and ambiguous statement - and asks for clarity as to what kind of positions are being talked about? Teaching positions .. administrative or director positions?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that we (administration) would have to look at it (the option) 'soup to nuts'. If there is redundancy or Transitions to speak to class size ... if there is a class that has a very low enrollment number and one school has a larger amount than another school, could we look at all the possibilities ... ? If redundancies were identified .. and just like as is being advocated for right now, if bringing on a new literacy program, we need to add literacy coaches to support the implementation of a brand new program, most likely it will be necessary to look to where we could cut something to bring about some kind of reconciliation. We will be looking at the entire district - that's why it says potential. It doesn't mean guaranteed but based on what we're working on right now, we're trying to look creatively to see what we can do.

Member Hays acknowledges and recognizes that there are going to be some tough choices to be made and is wondering at what point do we begin to actually get down to the nuts and bolts of what you're looking at. We are at the end of April already and she is assuming the Superintendent has already started looking at what kinds of positions might be considered. She is a little concerned when she hears about class size. If there are some that are very small ... she's hoping that we can start by looking at positions that don't directly affect students.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that is one of the pieces that we always look at who's closest to the students and don't directly impact them and is definitely taken into consideration. When she speaks of class size, she is not speaking of increasing class size to 35 students, but if there is a classroom with a low teacher/student (ratio) in one building and the same exact grade level in another building, that has a fuller portfolio, just looking at where they can be more equitable, is part of the analysis. Having back to back meetings with a short week last week, we're still in the process of pulling numbers and trying to calculate and now having a clear anticipated allocation of municipal hours and need to think differently and creatively. We have a proposed number; we need to look at what ways we can reconcile, where possible, and some of the positions Member Ruseau was talking about wanting to add to our cadre. It is going to go back to those scales in order to make a possible reconciliation. Being prudent and again with the subscriptions ... during Covid , we had a hybrid ... we had 1300 students that were

remote. We had purchased many online programs and some of them aren't having the usability that we thought would have continued post pandemic. We are (in the process of) getting the actual hard numbers for the usability of the programs to be able to make an informed decision. We have 30% participation where during the pandemic, it was 100% or 17%. It doesn't make sense to make for an entire district if we're not getting ... we might keep something but keep it in a limited capacity ... looking for those areas where we're being fiscally prudent and wise in that regard.

Member Graham asks if the \$74M that is listed on slide 13 - does that include the communications director?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent confirms it is. It wasn't listed as "we have a retirement" ..

Member Graham asks if it includes an Assistant Principal at the High School to bring the numbers to 4 instead of 3?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that currently at the high school, there are technically 4 people sitting in the titled role of assistant principal, including the vocational side of the house. We are looking at the high school very closely and Mr Welch will be presenting his recommendations for a potential structure for the high school at the May 1 Regular School Committee meeting. There are other ways we could get to the same amount of additional coverage but might not be, could be that we add an additional assistant principal - it could be through the addition of a different position. The short answer is yes, the high school is included - there could be more than one option that is presented as a potential structure to the committee.

Member Graham asks - the \$74M does not include any additional staffing over what there is there today?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds no.

Member Graham asks - the \$74M does not include any dollars associated with implementing the HECAT curriculum recommendation?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds no it definitely does not.

Member Graham asks if the \$74M contemplates the increased salary impacts of hiring 3 new principals and then the set of dominoes that could require

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds the \$74M would include what we were currently at right now; it may not include ... there is some consideration there, so yes

Member Graham comments - but no - right? ... if we have to pay one penny over what we're paying today then that is not in the \$74M.

Member McLaughlin: Point of Information - comment to the Chair, she is curious if you'll (the Chair) will clarify the dominoes you mentioned that the .. it's just the high school principals effect could have what we were referring to.

Member Graham comments she thinks that every time we bring in people at various levels, the people who have been in the district for 20 years or 15 years, look at the increase in salary that is being paid to somebody who just walked in the door - what about me? There is a set of dominoes that happens and is present right now in the marketplace, because people are unwilling to work for the rates they once were. We have a really thin labor pool and a lot of market pressure and we have to be prepared ... new high school principals are making at least \$40K more than our high school principals make. That's just a fact. If we want a high school principal, we're going to have to contend with that face in some fashion and then that creates a whole set of considerations that we need to be planning for.

Member Graham continues: she is finding it really hard to process what we're saying is our recommendation versus what we're saying is our doomsday scissors approach to get to the number we are likely to receive from the city. She would like everyone to think about how to make it clear as to what we believe we need to run the district next year. It's ok if that means we don't need subscriptions but subscriptions are not even close to remotely covering the gap that we're talking about here. She would like on May 1, 2023, for the presentation to be exclusively about what is our recommendation. It is our (the school committee's) job to advocate in front of the city and the mayor to tell the community what we need for our schools. If we don't do that, nobody will do that. It's really incumbent on us to lay that out thoughtfully, so when we look at that list and say yes - this is the number, we know that it means 1.0 literacy coaches. We know it means 2 FTE's for OT and speech therapy. Then we know what it means and we have to start crossing things off the list so it's really clear where we started and what hard decisions we had to make. Those hard decisions are 90% of our costs are people ... those hard decisions are about positions by and large. By May 1, we really need to have a crystal clear presentation that says here's the dollar amount for our contractual obligation. Only, here are the additions - here's what they each cost, so we are really clear. Then we can get to the hard decisions, which will have to come. We still don't know what the Consolidated House and Senate budget will be. We have the Governor's proposal, but we don't have the joint Ways and Means budget. What we do know is that the State has given us a few million dollars and not all of that is slated to come via the \$71M that we're anticipating being allocated. She would like to think there's an opportunity for us to make a case there and the city is sitting on \$25M of free cash. She would like to think there's an opportunity to demonstrate to the community that there is a very good reason to dip into the giant pile of free cash to get us through what is another lean year. This is her 4th year - her 4th budget. It's the 4th one - 3rd one that's bad ... there's a lot to talk about there. We can't do that unless we're clear on what it is that we thought we needed in the first place. She thinks it's really hard to understand what we're trying to accomplish by doing that.

Member Graham would like to make a motion ... is interrupted by ...

Member McLaughlin who is looking for a Point of Information. She speaks to slide 4 ... if she is understanding correctly, it's showing there will be another Budget meeting on May 1 and in between that and the school committee meeting request, there is going to be a meeting with the Superintendent's recommendations?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent confirms there will be a Budget Meeting on May 1, where she will be presenting her formal recommendations to the committee. The way the scheduled ended up being back to back meetings, along with a 4 day work week and a meeting last Monday, it really only left us 3 days. We then received the official anticipated allocation; she wanted the committee to be able to see that the anticipated number received - this is what we're thinking that between our ordinary expenses and our personnel expenses, we were anticipating a 6.8% increase. She wanted to provide the committee with that number. The 6.8% came up to approx. \$4.7M - which is why she was showing the approximate \$74M request ...

Member McLaughlin interrupts and states she still has the floor and comments that the Point of Information hasn't been answered. She continues ... she is still not understanding. On slide 4 under Budget Meetings, it is noted April 3, April 10 and May 1. In between school committee request and budget meetings, there is a Superintendent's Recommendation TBD. She is confused by that, when people are saying the May 1 meeting is going to be the Superintendent's Recommendation, because the graphic on page 4 suggests there is going to be time in between that for a meeting with the Superintendent's Recommendations.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent speaks and points out on Slide 5 she tried to map out the objectives as an homage to Member McLaughlin, where she has said to parse out what we were anticipating has been happening in terms of what the objectives have been thus far. At the May 1 meeting, her hope was to present her recommendations to the committee. That was going to give us time. We still have our parent community engagement meeting on April 26, to hear from members of the community who want to provide feedback or things they would like to see happen. She wanted that meeting to happen to

gather that additional data so that she would be able to fold that into her presentation on May 1. If we need to add another meeting, we can always do that as well.

Member Graham speaks - on the Budget priorities list, it is mentioned that 4 additional specialists are needed for the elementary school but it doesn't describe what they will do. What will they do?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds, they were intentionally vague on that. There are a lot of options being looked at. STEM, STEAM, potential literacy ... we have a couple of options on the table .. we're looking at which additional specialist will enhance the elementary schools the most. Not just for right now but long term. That's part of the conversation she is having with the Central Office team and one of the reasons why she references STEM is we did invest heavily in Foss science (?) and thinking about STEM and saying they had made a big investment in STEM and we are providing students with the maximum amount of STEM exposure as well. It is not fully defined as to what that position is going to be just yet in terms of part of our greater strategy at the elementary level, but we know we needed an additional 4.0 FTE's so one would be assigned to each school in order for the new schedule to work next year.

Member Ruseau interrupts with a Point of Information: when referencing specialists , we mean new teachers that are in the MTA - yes?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent confirms yes, they are part of the teachers union.

Member Ruseau asks - a specialist could mean anything? He doesn't think it's clear and he doesn't know if Member Graham was trying to ask - are we talking about 4 new teachers?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent confirms ...an offering, that we would be providing our students with that at the elementary levels.

Member Graham speaks - if she looks at page 15 and 16, if she adds up the columns about FY24, she gets about \$2M and \$2,020M (two million and twenty thousand), it looks like we have \$3.2M. Does that mean we have only anticipated ESSER spending with still about \$1.1M to go? She is having a hard time making the math add up to \$3.2M - and she's not sure if it's supposed to - she can't tell if something is missing or if it's just that we haven't decided how to use that remaining \$1M.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent comments that slide 15 is the best estimate of where we think we are and we do have a few TBD's. We are looking on our end, what has to be on ESSER, what potentially be on operating. That is why there is a little wiggle room. The current ESSER, when we did the calculation, was at \$3.2M as a balance. ... and you're saying you're not sure?

Member Graham yes ... she comments she is calculating what we're planning to spend in FY24. We have \$3.2M, so there is still \$1M untouched - is that correct?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent confirms - yes that is correct. When we were meeting and she referenced \$750K, she was trying to say could we carry a few of the programs on to FY25. If we did not spend all \$3.2M right now during FY24, could we squirrel away \$750K to help pay for some of the programs and not people. That would leave us with a little extra cushion for FY25 operating budget. As of September 30, 2023, ESSER is gone and it's not coming back.

Member Graham makes a motion that the Superintendent's Recommendation on May 1 will only contain our recommendation for the FY24 budget and that it will not simultaneously seek to deal with hard decisions that might need to be made.

Member McLaughlin would like a Point of Information. She would like some clarification on that. If we're going back to the schedule of what we're talking about, if May 1 is the Superintendent's Recommendation and we are having a public meeting and then hold a school committee meeting to discuss, she would like to clarify, if through the chair, Member Graham is asking that what the Superintendent presents on May 1

is her recommendation, not back into an allocation, because we haven't really asked for the allocation at that point. She is asking for some clarity on what the motions is actually asking for.

Member Graham: she is asking that the presentation on May 1 be purely our (school committee's) request to the municipal government for what we believe we need in FY24 to operate Medford Public Schools in a responsible manner.

Member McLaughlin (*mic issue ... unclearly as to what she is saying*) - when you say our, who is our ... ?

Member Graham: comments yes, the school committee

Member McLaughlin makes reference to what they (municipal government??) want is not our (school committee) .. ?

Chair Lungo-Koehn - comments yes, that is correct and ... just from the floor, we're pushing into May and there has been allocations, so we do have to start making the tough choices, or at least the planning has to be done by central May 1. Calls Point of Order - Member Ruseau

Member Ruseau speaks - the committee decides what the process will be, receiving a memo that tells us what we're going to get from allocation does not change what this body will do. We have a process that we have implemented for 3 years now and we will create a request that will say what we need to operate this district, regardless of what the municipality is going to give us, that unless the committee decides to change our process, that is what we're going to do. Getting a memo does not immediately decide that we don't have to do our jobs and the Superintendent doesn't have to tell us what's needed to make this district function and flourish. Those are not related things. He disagrees very much that receiving that memo last Friday suddenly short circuits our process.

Chair Lungo-Koehn comments from the chair, she is not saying it does at all, but in the past you (?) haven't had a number this soon to at least be able to somewhat plan, even if they ask us for more than what is allocated.

Member McLaughlin seeks a Point of Information: what she is asking for is clarification between the Superintendent's Recommendation and the School Committee's Recommendation, because those could potentially be 2 different things. The Superintendent, on May 1, if she is going to share her recommendations with the committee, based on the information that she's given up to this point, then she (M.McL) assumes that on May 1, is what she is representing as the Superintendent, as her recommendation. Then according to this schedule, and this is what she is trying to differentiate, to Member Ruseau's point, there is potentially a difference between what the school committee recommendation might be for the allocation and potentially what the Superintendent's might be. So that is exactly the point and she is trying to get clarification on the motion ... looking at the calendar to find when we're meeting to decide what we're going to put forward to our school committee request - May 15 or June 5. That's a substantial amount of time between May 1 with the Superintendent making her recommendation. We still have to have the Public Meeting and then we decide what our allocation is. Not May 1. She hears what people want, which is a real understanding of what our school needs in terms of not back into a number. She agrees with that but doesn't understand the motion for May 1 because that's at the Superintendent's discretion and then it's the school committee's job is to decide whether they accept that or not.

Member Graham speaks and is fine with that. Her ask is that when the Superintendent makes that recommendation to us (the committee), it is not muddled with hard decisions that she has to work on in parallel. She recognizes that reality. We (the committee) can't do their jobs unless they hear from her what she thinks the district needs to operate. What we can't do on May 1 is get a mish-mash of 'what I need and what I know I'm going to get', because then we (the committee) cannot do their job. She is asking that the Superintendent's recommendation be clear and distinct about what she is asking this City to provide on her behalf. If we have things to add and change, that's what would happen after that meeting. By and large, it's going to be what she recommends. We think small things change every year, but wholesale changes cannot be made without the right data. We need a basis that is clear and clean.

Member McLaughlin seeks a Point of Information - she would like to understand and have clarification in terms of what is needed; she is asking if the \$74M that is being spoken about in this meeting ... versus what her recommendation might be?

Member Graham answers that it doesn't contain any of the things on the needs slide ... refers to slide 18 - none of these things are in \$74M Nor is the HECAT ... nor is ... (audio lost in multiple comments occurring simultaneously) ...

Member McLaughlin ... is there any changes - are none of the priorities are ??

Member Graham answers correct

Member McLaughlin states that none of the budgetary priorities are included. They were included under ESSER and will be expiring 2024 - they are not included in the \$74M that she (the superintendent's) recommending/talking about. Seeks confirmation of this statement.

Member Graham answers that is her understanding and that is why we need a clear picture of what the ask is. She states there is no second on the motion.

Motion that the Superintendent's Recommendation on May 1 will only contain our recommendation for the FY24 budget and that it will not simultaneously seek to deal with hard decisions that might need to be made.

Member Hays seconds the motion.

Chair Lungo-Koehn confirms the motion by member Graham and seconded by Member Hays and calls for a roll-call by Member Ruseau.

Motion passes 5/2

Member Kreatz and Mayor Lungo-Koehn respond in the negative.

Member Kreatz her questions have been answered; the same question about the specialist of 4.0 and the reductions. Going back to the motion, she is unclear on slide 18, budget priorities - it's critical that we get the OT, the SOP 2.0. Additionally, the elementary specialists - asks if these are going to be funded with the ESSER money and not the budget money?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that those would be coming under the operating budget, so these are other budgetary priorities that are needed. We would want them on the regular operating - the general fund. This was not allocated; not thinking about them for ESSER with this being year 3 or the final year of ESSER, these positions were wanted to be on an operating budget.

Member Kreatz asks for clarification on that. In the number for the \$74M, are these needs in that number or are these going to have to be built into that number?

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that the \$74M is inclusive of how the Fixed costs ... how we got to the 3 point ... the 1.4 (ordinary expenses - the non salary, transportation, cleaning costs, etc - are low - nothing really ne was a 6.8% increase totally \$4.7M - which is approx. \$74M) .. the \$3.3M is for CBA's - contracts - those personnel expenses that are a guaranteed amount. This is not including the new positions of the elementary teachers, the 4 elementary specialists teaching positions, the occupational therapist, speech and language pathologist - those are just 6 positions that we currently do not have right now and are positions we will need for next year. That number is what the calculations are for Medford Public Schools to continue functioning the way it is right now. Increased bills and settled CBA's (still have 4 more that are being worked on. The \$3.3M will go up by the end of the year.

Member Kreatz continues - on slide 19, what are some of the examples of the deferral of some of the strategic priorities - she is curious as to what those might be.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds that she and Member Hays were communicating earlier in the day regarding some additional supplemental deferred priorities from last year that were not able to be met.

Chair Lungo-Koehn comments that It looks like the \$74M doesn't include the 2 to 3.2M; there will be a \$5.6M budget gap - a devastating cliff next year and the following year if "that was ever how we want to operate". She continues to comment that you (the superintendent) does what she needs to on May 1, however, at the same time, she respectfully asks that central administration do the hard work and even if she doesn't present it until the 15th, that it be done because you cannot use free cash to sustain a \$6M budget gap - it will be devastating.

Superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent responds with an example of a deferred position such as a transportation coordinator - that was a deferred position that was prioritized a year ago, that didn't end up happening. There were other positions that were hoped for and some of the interventions ended up being deferred positions.

Member Hays speaks and states that we need to be clear with people when using the word deferred, which is a nice way to say, we're not able to fund it. Many, if not all positions that were deferred last year, are not going to be funded this year. If she understands correctly, we (the committee) were told in the past that next year might be an even more difficult fiscal year. Some of these were literacy interventionists at the high school, career counselors at the high school, math coaches. These were things (positions) that were felt, the students needed. Calling them deferred means we can't fund them and are not likely to be funded in the next year or two.

Chair Lungo-Koehn provides an example as discussed in the City Council floor, that Newton did a \$90M or \$100M override for two new schools - that passed. Their \$10M override for the Budget School and General Fund Budget failed. It's not something we can depend on for the priorities on the city and school side. Same issues exist on the City side with 10 new positions being requested, including public safety and another 10 covered by arbor that is also going to reach a cliff. They are planning accordingly and are going to start not filling positions as they become vacated. They are also making sure that anybody hired that specifically says in their offer letter, this is a one year position, paid for by operating And will not be covered after a specifically stated date - just like we're doing it on the City side, we're going to have some serious issues.

Member Graham agrees they need to hear about the next step really quickly. She makes ***a motion that the superintendent will present her plan to close the gap that we know will exist at the May 15 meeting.***

Motion seconded by Member Hays.
Motion carries 7/0

Member Ruseau speaks. He looked at the cherry sheets and the amount of revenue the state plans to send to Medford. This year, Medford is getting a 20% increase and will receive \$3.76M more than the State says is for education. Communities and cities do have the freedom to spend that money any way they want. The Mayor could use it for pavement which is legal and allowed. He finds it very concerning that the state believes we need \$3.76M more for education and we're only getting 45% of that in this new budget. That 55% of the money the mayor is choosing to do something else with, which is 100% her authority and we (the committee) can do nothing about it. He thinks it's really important. This sub (?) \$3.76M is the Governor's budget - that usually goes up as the legislation gets their hands on their proposed budgets. This number is almost certainly going to go up. He was surprised to see what the cherry sheets said and the Governor's budget said we should be getting more for education. Those numbers speak for themselves.

Chair Lungo-Koehn looks for a motion on the floor to adjourn.

***Motion to adjourn by Member Graham; seconded by Member McLaughlan
Motion carries 7/0***

Meeting adjourns: 5:34p